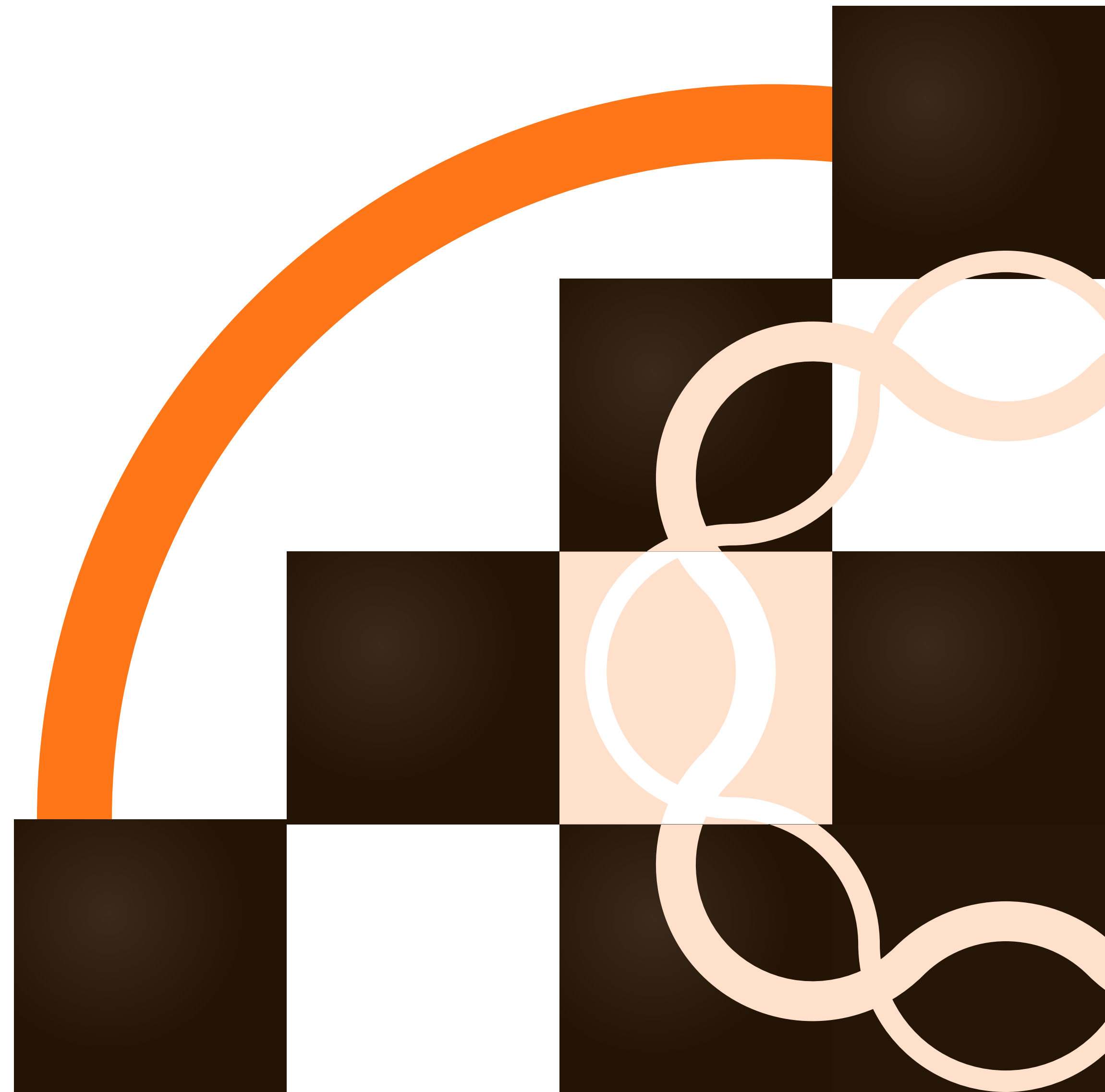




AEM: 

A COMPLETE PLAYBOOK FOR A SEAMLESS UPGRADE

AUGUST 14TH, 2024



About Us



**Humanizing Digital Experiences
Through Data, Creativity & Technology**

TechChefz Digital (TCZ Digital Private Ltd) is a new breed of innovative digital transformation agency, redefining storytelling for an always-on world. Our mission goes beyond mere engagement. We aim to transform brand-audience interactions by delivering rich, integrated experiences across various platforms and enabling omnichannel commerce.

Our all-encompassing solutions are with careful precision tailored for leaders in marketing, business, and technology, focusing on three key pillars: Digital Experience, Custom Development, and Cloud Transformation. With strategic global bases in Dubai, London, the US, and India, our international reach ensures that we can assist businesses in embracing the digital era with cutting-edge strategies and solutions.

TechChefz Digital offers a comprehensive range of services, including bespoke solutions for user acquisition, engagement, conversion, and operational excellence.

Our team is committed to providing unparalleled support to our clients and partners, guiding them on their journey to digital mastery with expertise and innovation.

Our commitment is to lead the way in reshaping the digital landscape, continuously exploring new frontiers of technology and creativity. We invite you to join us in this mission, as we help businesses worldwide adopt a vibrant digital culture and unlock their full potential in the modern digital ecosystem. With TechChefz Digital, the future of digital innovation is not only about keeping up, but also about setting new benchmarks for success.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Overview of the Playbook

Key Phases in AEM Upgrade

Steps Involved in AEM Upgrade

- Put Together a Summary of Every Process Associated with the Upgrade
- Clarify the objectives and scope of the Author Training Upgrade Plan.
- Establish a Test Strategy.
- Assess Architecture and Infrastructure Changes That Are Necessary.
- Determine the Upgrade's Complexity
- For the upgrade, create a rollback runbook.
- Provide a thorough project plan.
- Carry out development and QA
- Verify the Runbook in Advance of the Last Testing
- To implement the upgrade, run the runbook.
- Provide Assistance Following Upgrading

Conclusion

Overview of the Playbook

In today's digital era, enhancing customer experiences is a top priority for organizations of all sizes. Adobe continually updates the Adobe Experience Cloud suite to provide marketers with tools to create and deliver outstanding experiences.

Adobe Experience Manager (AEM) is a cornerstone of this suite, offering annual updates with new features and improvements. Upgrading AEM is essential to leverage these advancements and deliver superior omnichannel experiences.

While Adobe provides some support for upgrading AEM, the process can be complex, requiring specialized knowledge for smooth execution.

Proper planning is crucial, encompassing author training, test case development, architectural understanding, effort estimation using Adobe's pattern detector, and project plan creation. The upgrade process involves multiple phases, each with specific deliverables.

This guide aims to help you navigate the AEM upgrade process, establishing clear goals and phases for a successful upgrade.

Let's explore each step in detail:



Steps Involved in AEM Upgrade

- 1

Put Together a Summary of Every Process Associated with the Upgrade
- 2

Clarify the objectives and scope of the Author Training Upgrade Plan.
- 3

Establish a Test Strategy.
- 4

Assess Architecture and Infrastructure Changes That Are Necessary.
- 5

Determine the Upgrade's Complexity
- 6

For the upgrade, create a rollback runbook.
- 7

Provide a thorough project plan.
- 8

Carry out development and QA
- 9

Verify the Runbook in Advance of the Last Testing
- 10

To implement the upgrade, run the runbook.

Key Phases in AEM Upgrade

1. Overview of the Upgrade Process

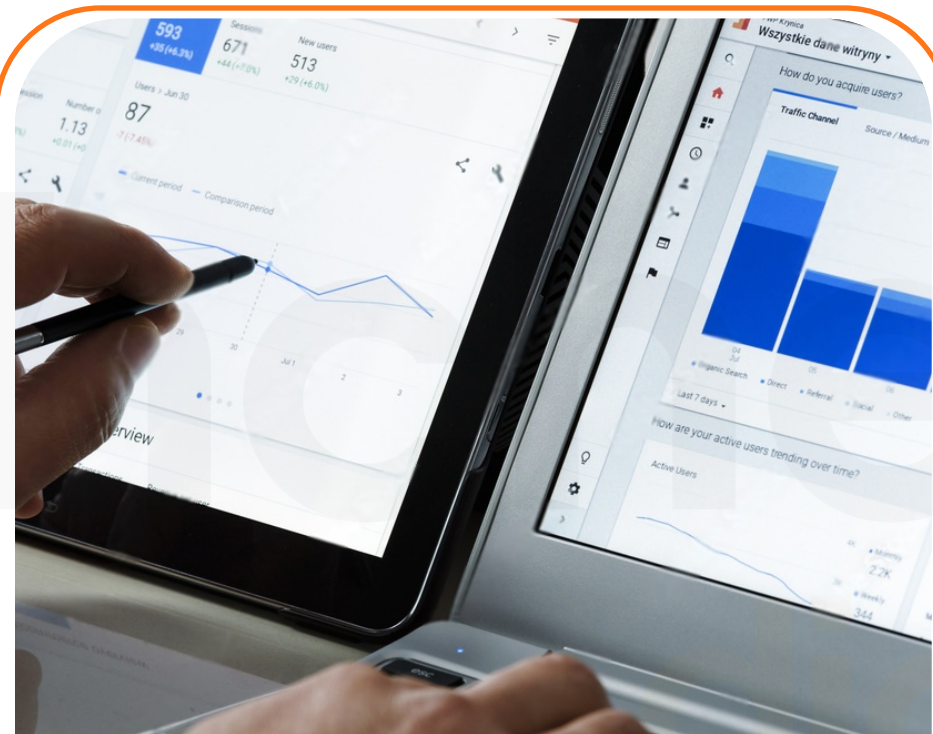
The AEM upgrade process is multi-faceted and can span several months. Below is a high-level overview of the essential steps involved:



Planning: Develop author training plans, and test plans, identify architectural changes, use pattern detectors for effort estimation, and prepare a runbook.



Development & QA: Create dedicated code branches, assess resource resolver usage, list queries, and indexes, customize updates, and update overlays.



Pre-Upgrade Maintenance: Ensure resource efficiency, back up existing resources, automate pre-upgrade maintenance analysis, disable custom logins, and rotate logs.

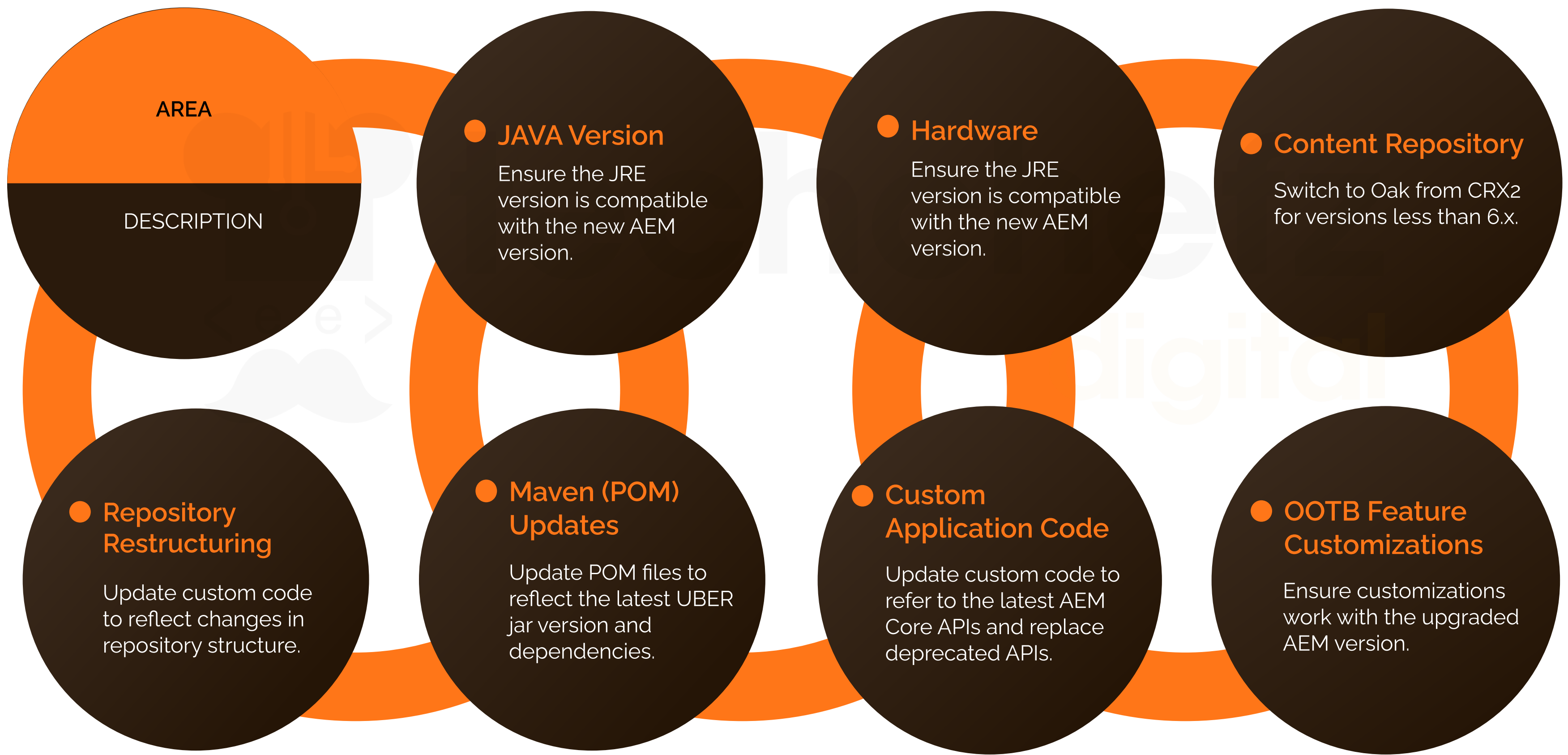


Upgrade Execution: Stop authoring, update the author tier, segregate publish instances, upgrade major and additional instances, and finalize the upgrade.

Post-Upgrade Inspection: Examine log files, check bundles, reinstall backup configurations, determine maintenance tasks, and troubleshoot issues.

2. Define Upgrade Scope and Requirements

Ensure your operating system, Java runtime, HTTP, and Dispatcher versions are supported before starting the upgrade. Include necessary components in the project plan. Key areas impacted during an AEM upgrade include:



3. Plan for Author Training

Review functional changes introduced in the upgraded AEM version and create a training plan for your authors. Note changes to UIs or frequently used product features, and develop a comprehensive training plan.

4. Develop a Test Plan

Identify all customizations made to the AEM system and include them in a test plan. This empowers the QA process, performed on the upgraded instance, to ensure all applications and custom code run as desired.

5. Evaluate Architectural and Infrastructure Changes

Upgrading may require updates to other components in your technical stack, such as the operating system or JVM.

Additional hardware may be necessary due to repository changes, particularly when migrating from pre-6.x instances. Update operational practices, including monitoring, maintenance, and backup and disaster recovery processes.

6. Assess Upgrade Complexity

Use the Pattern Detector, available for AEM 6.1, 6.2, and 6.3 instances, to assess upgrade complexity. This tool provides a report identifying unavailable APIs in the custom codebase, offering an accurate estimate of the upgrade's complexity. Additionally, perform an upgrade on a test instance with basic smoke testing and review deprecated and removed features.

7. Prepare an Upgrade and Rollback Runbook

Create a project-specific runbook outlining the upgrade and rollback procedures, tailored to your organization's network layout, deployment architecture, and customizations. Review all instructions considering your system architecture, customizations, and downtime tolerance to determine appropriate switch-over and rollback procedures.



8. Develop a Comprehensive Project Plan

Develop a project plan covering expected timelines for testing, development efforts, training, and actual upgrade execution. The project plan should include:

- Finalization of development and test plans
- Upgrading development and QA environments
- Updating the custom code base for AEM 6.5
- QA test and fix cycle
- Upgrading the staging environment
- Integration, performance, and load testing
- Environment certification
- Go-live

9. Perform Development and QA

Track newly discovered issues and adjust the upgrade process accordingly. Ensure the code base is fully validated and ready for deployment to the stage environment after testing and fixing.

10. Conduct Final Testing

Conduct a final round of testing after the QA team certifies the codebase. Validate the runbook on the stage environment, followed by user acceptance, performance, and security testing. Perform performance, load, and security tests to identify significant changes to the underlying platforms in the new AEM version.

11. Execute the Upgrade

Once all stakeholders give the green light, execute the runbook procedures to perform the final upgrade. Follow the detailed steps outlined in the runbook to ensure a smooth transition.

12. Provide Post-Upgrade Support

Plan for post-upgrade support to ensure minimal disruption to your live site(s). Budget for post-upgrade warranty/support if you hired a vendor. Allocate sufficient internal resources to address any issues identified in production.



Conclusion

Each AEM upgrade is unique, presenting specific challenges. Partnering with an experienced firm like TechChefz Digital can be crucial for a successful upgrade. TechChefz Digital specializing in marketing cloud and technology implementations, is recognized for its expertise in AEM and Adobe Marketing Cloud. We are equipped to assist with your AEM implementations, upgrades, or managed services.



Humanizing Digital Experiences
Through Data, Creativity & Technology

HQ India, Noida

4th Floor, Insignia Tower, Subarea, Sector 126, Noida,
Uttar Pradesh - 201313



Contact

TechChefz Digital today at
hello@techchefz.com for assistance
with your AEM upgrade.